

than sharing posters of all the upcoming movies you didn't even know were in the pipeline! And many more like them...

While we try to define ourselves using the type of content that we share, an interesting question that arises is, why do we feel the need to define ourselves like this? That is one question that doesn't have a clear answer. Perhaps, the need to define oneself, to have an identity is linked to our innate need to be understood and loved for what we are, or maybe the need is more social than personal-you have to create a respectable/likeable image of yourself so that you are more accepted by the members of the social circle you move in. To this end, sharing certain types of content might be beneficial.

One meaningful study which gives insights about the aspect of sharing social content was conducted by The New York Times. The study entitled, "The Psychology of Sharing: Why People Share Online" brings out these significant pieces of information:

Around 85 percent of people who participated in the study says that reading responses from other people helps them understand and process the various information and events they come across.

Some 73 percent of the participants said that they are able to process information more thoroughly when they share it.

In other words, the act of sharing improves our comprehension of matters. And we can perhaps surmise that an improved understanding would help us make better life or career decisions leading to an improved quality of life.

Where it's seen:

Bitwell is a company that creates motorcycle accessories. And if that doesn't make them cool enough, they periodically update their Facebook page with awesome fan helmet art. It allows these fans' works to be viewed by a lot of users and also gives the fans an opportunity to assert their identity- after all, expressing in any form is expressing an aspect of who you are.

2. To bring entertainment/useful content to others

There could be multiple reasons why you would want to do this- to bring to others the teaser trailer of a blockbuster or a video that illustrates how to create a beautiful lamp using discarded items found in your home.

For one thing, you would want to be someone who entertains, or who is useful to others- something linked to the idea of social acceptance.